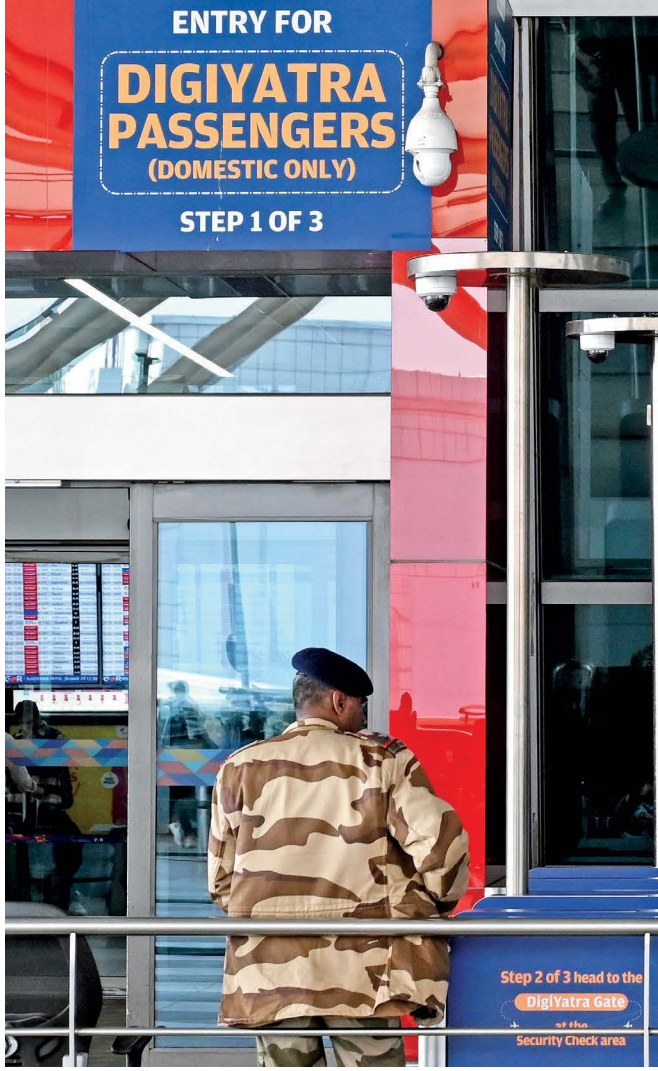
GATEWAY TO COMFORT

Bypassing long queues and frequent documentation checks, flyers are discovering the joys of seamless airport check-in with the DigiYatra app

By AVISHEK G. DASTIDAR



DIGIYATRA
Launched in 2022

Achievement: The app has benefitted 9.2 million users in 24 airports across India

THE DRUDGERY

For a long time, navigating airports before boarding a flight robbed the joy out of any journey by air. The check-in process, often the first hurdle, meant having to stand in long queues and rifling through boarding passes and identity proofs. A simple oversight, like forgetting an ID at home, could completely derail travel plans. For new or infrequent flyers, the process could be especially nerve-wracking. At every stage—from the entry gate to baggage drop and security screening—flyers would be asked to produce documents and subjected to manual checks. It also meant they had to pass through a series of cumbersome touchpoints. The stress of ensuring every document was in order while trying to stay on schedule made flying an anxiety-laden experience for many. A convenient solution to this ordeal was urgently needed.

THE EASE OF LIVING

Over the past decade, DigiYatra has emerged as a transformative innovation, redefining air travel in India. Launched in December 2022, this government-backed mobile app streamlines airport procedures by eliminating paper documents and repetitive checks. Travellers simply upload their boarding pass and biometrics—linked during registration via Aadhaar or another government ID—into the app, leaving the system to handle the rest.

At the airport, passengers head directly to the DigiYatra gate, where facial recognition technology verifies their identity in seconds, granting instant access. Airlines such as IndiGo and Air India have introduced exclusive check-in counters for DigiYatra users, while special security gates with facial scanners enable swift clearance before physical frisking. The app removes the need to juggle printed passes, ID proofs and baggage tags, making long queues and last-minute panic a thing of the past.

DigiYatra is part of India's wider Digital Public Infrastructure, alongside UPI and DigiLocker, and has been lauded for how it has cut messy, obtrusive protocol. In a 2024 speech to the Indian diaspora in the US, Prime Minister Narendra Modi highlighted its benefits, stating, "Many Indians no longer use physical folders for papers. They have DigiLocker. When going